



TIPS & TRICKS



Using apt-get with a proxy server

Linux users often want to install new software and updates or upgrade their systems through the *apt-get* command but they are unable to do anything because of a connection error that occurs even if the Internet connection is working well. This happens particularly when you use the Internet from behind a proxy server. Here is a tip to overcome this issue—add details about the proxy server to *apt.conf*.

Open the file */etc/apt/apt.conf* in a text editor and add the lines as shown below:

```
Acquire::http::proxy "http://username:password@
YourproxyAddress:portname/";
Acquire::ftp::proxy "ftp://username:password@
YourproxyAddress:portname/";
Acquire::https::proxy "https://username:password@
YourproxyAddress:portname/";
```

Here, the username and password are provided by your network administrator. If your network proxy setup does not require a password, then keep it blank.

For example:

```
Acquire::http::proxy "http://linux:1234@webproxy.
ac.in:8080/";
```

—Ankit Agrawal,
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Adding Indic fonts

After installing openSUSE on my laptop, I just wanted to update my FB status. When I opened my profile, I found only the blocks and bricks. Yes, this was due to the missing Indian fonts. But don't panic. All you need to do is to run the following command to install the fonts:

```
sudo zypper in indic-fonts
```

After successful installation of the new fonts, just restart your browser to enjoy them.

—Karthikeyan,
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Find the length of a string

Here is a simple way to get to know the length of a given string. The method can have different applications, depending on your requirements.

To get the length, open your terminal and run the following command:

```
a="Hi There"
echo ${#a}
```

The output of the above command will be...

```
8
```

You can also apply this method in a script to get the length:

```
#!/bin/bash
#
for i in `ls -l`
do
    echo Length of Filename $i :- ${#i}
done
```

The output will include details of all the files in the folder as shown below:

```
Length of Filename Screenshot-9.png :- 16
Length of Filename Screenshot-EC.png :- 17
Length of Filename Sheet1.png :- 10
Length of Filename New-Doc.doc :- 11
Length of Filename New--ment.pdf :- 13
Length of Filename Unsaved :- 7
Length of Filename Document :- 8
```

—Sanjay Rokade,
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Check the IP address of a live machine in your local network

If you have multiple Linux machines in your local network, you can run a scan using *nmap* on the network to check the IP address of a live system.

```
nmap -sV -p 22 192.168.1.1-255
```